



MOBILE GAMING EXPERIENCES ARE GETTING AN UPGRADE

Your mobile gaming experience just got better!

By Jayesh "Big Daddy" Shinde

feedback@skoar.in

Imagine watching a game of IPL T20 cricket on a big screen television and compare it with a cricket game you play on your smartphone: Which one offers more fun and entertainment in terms of vibe? Short of physically witnessing a live cricket game inside the stadium, watching it on the tele is significantly better than any cricket game you can play anywhere. Until now.

Epic Cricket is a popular smartphone and tablet-based cricket simulation game developed by Moong Labs, which recently worked with Dolby Laboratories to incorporate Dolby Atmos virtual surround sound effect to enhance the game's user experience. That's right, they're trying to bring some of that vibe and feel of a live cricket match into a virtual game on your smartphone.

Importance of audio in immersive gaming

According to Moong Labs, "complex algorithms and techniques" are deployed to impact Epic Cricket gamers' visual and auditory senses – a distinct loud roar of the crowd from the direction of the stands where the ball travels, wicketkeeper chatting behind the stumps, among other things, definitely aim to get you more involved into the game, no doubt.

As any self-respecting gamer will tell you, great gaming experiences are powered by great immersive experiences. Without immersing yourself into a game, you don't really feel you're 'in the game', do you? The eyes and ears play a big role for that to happen, whether you're playing Call of Duty or DOTA 2 or any of your favourite games out there.

Samit Babbar, Head of Product, Moong Labs said, "Gamers today want immersive experiences from their games and Dolby Atmos allows us to bring a whole new level of immersive gameplay." It's an attempt to take gamers right into the middle of the action with spatial sound as experienced by cricketers in a real match, he added further, as gamers spend more time playing sports-based games on their smartphones.

Dolby Laboratories' Ashim Mathur agreed with Moong Labs' Samit Babbar. "From a technology standpoint, Dolby Atmos adapts automatically to mobile devices and tablets to give you a spatial sound experience," said Ashim Mathur, Senior Regional Director, Japan & Emerging Markets, Dolby Laboratories.

He claimed Dolby Atmos allows creative professionals like game developers total control over the placement and movement of each

sound, helping them create a rich and layered spatial experience for gamers – even on mobile gaming devices, believe it or not. "With greater precision and detail than traditional surround sound mixing, creators can fine-tune the perfect mix," to deliver the exact soundscape for players of Epic Cricket, for instance, despite all the challenges thrown about by mobile form factors.

Here we'd like to point you to insights from Jayant Shah, Director Apps & Solutions Engineering, Emerging Markets at Dolby Laboratories who demystified how better Dolby Atmos audio experiences are now becoming available at increasingly lower price points for consumers in India.

"At a hardware level, we integrate with the chipset. The coding, the decoders, and all the magic is present inside the chipset. In terms of form factors, there's no restriction saying only the really high-end phones can support Dolby Atmos, so we don't limit the hardware. Obviously, sometimes, there's a detrimental aspect. For instance, you need at least two speakers. So, you know, there are some minimum specifications that are required. But beyond that, we don't restrict. To that end, there are some OEMs that come to us right at